Project 3: Persons Required

Assignment Instructions

AI 201 — ASSIGNMENT BRIEF
Project 3: Persons Required
Find one person. Understand their problem. Build something that helps. Ship the proof.

Due Date	Weight	Submission	
Wed, May 27, 2026	**40% of Final Grade**	Live URL + Case Study	I

You have spent this quarter learning to direct AI as an Art Director. You've built screens. You've built systems. Now build something that matters.

Find one real person in your life who is struggling with something. Not a persona. Not a demographic. A human being you can sit across from and talk to. Understand their problem. Design and build something that helps them. Put it in their hands. Document what happens.

The **platform is your design decision**. React, Unity, Unreal, a Chrome extension, a mobile app, a Discord bot, a projected installation, a Figma plugin — the person you're helping determines where this thing needs to live. You must defend that choice.

The deliverable is not an app. The deliverable is evidence that you helped someone.

Milestone Schedule

Session	Date	Milestone
Session 13	Mon 5/4	**The Room Debate.** Who needs help and why do you care? Thesis pitch to the room.
Session 14	Wed 5/6	**Research & Field Work.** Interview your person. Document the problem. Platform decision defended. Design Argument due.
Session 15	Mon 5/11	**Build begins.** Design Intent locked. AI translates your spec into a working prototype.
Session 16	Wed 5/13	★ **FIRST CONTACT.** Put the prototype in front of your person. Document what happens. Not a crit — a field test.
Session 17	Mon 5/18	**Iteration.** Rebuild based on what you learned. Second test if possible. Collect evidence.
Session 18	Wed 5/20	**The Case Study.** Build the story: the person, the problem, the prototype, the evidence. QA and polish.
Session 19	Mon 5/25	**Final Polish.** Live URL verified. Git history clean. Case study presentation rehearsed.
Session 20	Wed 5/27	★ **PREMIERE + STUDIO CRIT.** Present the case study. Not a demo — a defense. The person, the problem, the proof.

What You Turn In

A shipped product, research documentation, evidence of real use, and a case study presentation. Everything ships together.

Design Argument — Not a color palette. A thesis. Who is this person? What's broken for them? What does "helped" look like? Why are you the one building this? Written before AI engagement. This is the standard against which you evaluate everything.
Research Documentation — Interview notes or quotes. Photos of the environment (with permission). Observed pain points. The actual context this person lives and works in. You cannot design for someone you haven't listened to.
Platform Rationale — Why does this thing live where it lives? A React app? A Unity build? A Chrome extension? A physical kiosk? The person you're helping determines the platform. Defend the choice.
Shipped Product — A functional, polished tool hosted live or delivered as a built application. It must work. It must be in the hands of the person you designed it for.
User Testing Evidence — Documented evidence of your person using the prototype. What happened? What did they reach for that wasn't there? What did they ignore? What surprised you? Photos, screen recordings, quotes, notes.
Mermaid Diagram — Full system architecture. What receives input, how the system processes it, what it outputs. In your GitHub repo.
AI Direction Log (5+ entries) — This is a bigger project. More entries. What you asked AI to do, what it produced, what you changed/rejected/kept and why.
Records of Resistance (3+ moments) — Documented moments where you rejected or significantly revised AI output. What did AI produce? Why did you reject it? What did you do instead?
Five Questions Reflection — Completed before submission. These hit different when the person you're helping has a name.
Post-Mortem — Written reflection on your full Design Cycle. What worked? What failed? What would you do differently? What did you learn about designing for a real person vs. a hypothetical user?
Case Study Presentation — Session 20. Not a demo. A defense. The person, the problem, the research, the prototype failures, the iteration, the evidence. This is a portfolio-ready case study, not a slide deck of screenshots.
Marketing Minute - As part of your final presentation deliver a 60 second commercial for your solution. Pretend this commercial might run on either YouTube or Instagram. Consider the formatting and solve for both. This is your portfolio piece. This is your artifact for the class.

Grading (100 pts)

Category	Pts	Meets Expectations	Below Expectations
Design Argument & Research	**20**	Clear thesis: names a real person, a real problem, and a defensible definition of "helped." Research is specific — interview quotes, environmental context, observed pain points. Not invented. Not assumed.	Vague, generic, or fictional. No evidence of direct contact with the person. Problem is assumed, not observed. Thesis written after the build.
Shipped Product & Marketing Minute	**25**	Functional, polished, and appropriate to the platform. Solves the stated problem. Accessible to the person it was built for. Hosted or delivered.	Broken, unfinished, or disconnected from the stated problem. Platform choice is unjustified. Not accessible to the intended user.

User Testing & Evidence	**15**	Documented evidence of the real person using the prototype. Specific observations: what worked, what failed, what surprised. Evidence of iteration based on testing.	No evidence of real use. Testing was with classmates only. No iteration based on feedback. Evidence is fabricated or generic.
Platform Rationale	**5**	Platform choice is driven by the person and the problem. Defended with specificity. The thing lives where it needs to live.	Platform is the default, not a decision. No rationale. React because React.
AI Direction Log	**10**	5+ entries showing what was asked, produced, and decided. Demonstrates editorial judgment across a complex build.	Missing, fewer than 5 entries, or generic. No evidence of direction.
Records of Resistance	**10**	3+ documented rejections/revisions. Each names what AI gave, what you did instead, and why. At this project scale, resistance should be substantive.	Missing or shallow. No real evidence of critical evaluation.
Mermaid Diagram	**5**	Accurate system architecture showing input, processing, and output. Matches the built project.	Missing, inaccurate, or does not reflect the actual project.
Case Study + Post-Mortem	**10**	Presentation tells the full story: person, problem, research, build, test, evidence. Post-Mortem is honest and specific. Portfolio-ready.	Demo only — no research, no evidence, no story. Post-Mortem is perfunctory. Cannot explain process or defend decisions.
TOTAL	**100**		

How to Submit

Push your final code to your GitHub repository.
Verify your live URL works in an incognito browser window (or provide the appropriate deliverable for your platform).
Ensure your README contains:

1. Design Argument
2. Research Documentation
3. Platform Rationale
4. AI Direction Log
5. Records of Resistance
6. Five Questions reflection
7. Post-Mortem
8. Mermaid diagram
9. Upload your User Testing Evidence (photos, recordings, notes) to your repo or link them in your README.
10. Submit your live URL and case study materials to Blackboard under the Project 3 assignment.

Prepare your case study presentation for Session 20.

■ PLATFORM IS A DESIGN DECISION: React is our shared classroom language, but this project opens the door. If your person needs a Unity experience, a Chrome extension, a mobile app, a physical installation, or something else entirely — that's the right answer. Discuss your platform choice with me during Session 13. Your Design Argument must account for the platform. The ESF practices (AI Direction Log, Records of Resistance, Five Questions) are identical across all pipelines.

*See also: **Persons Required — Context & Framework** for the ID research process, ESF practices explained, user testing guidance, case study format, and academic policies.*